Continuous Delivery Health Check

Score twelve practices that make releasing safe and routine, find the biggest gaps, and pick experiments to close them.

Engineering Practices · Inspired by DORA research, Accelerate (Forsgren, Humble & Kim) and Continuous Delivery (Humble & Farley)

TEAM _____

DATE _____

1 Practices

VOTE SILENTLY · 1 NOT YET · 3 SOMETIMES · 5 ALWAYS

	SCORE 1 2 3 4 5	NOTES / EVIDENCE
BUILD & INTEGRATE		
Version control for everything Code, tests, configuration and infrastructure are all versioned.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Small, short-lived branches Work merges to main at least daily (trunk-based development).	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Continuous integration Every merge builds and tests automatically, in minutes.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
TEST		
Test automation we trust A green run means we're confident; flaky tests get fixed.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Test data on demand Anyone can get realistic test data without waiting.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Security built in Security checks run in the pipeline, not just before release.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
DEPLOY & RELEASE		
Automated deployment Deploying to any environment is one click, or none.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Deploy separate from release Feature flags or similar let us switch features on later.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Small batches Changes reach production in small pieces, often.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
RUN & LEARN		
Monitoring & observability We know quickly when something's wrong for users.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Fast recovery We can roll back or fix forward in minutes, and practise it.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Learning from failure Incidents lead to blameless reviews and real changes.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	

2 Biggest Gaps

LOWEST SCORES · WIDEST SPREAD

Add your sticky notes here

3 Experiments

ONE OR TWO, SMALL

Practice: _____

We'll try: _____

Owner / check on: _____

Practice: _____

We'll try: _____

Owner / check on: _____

4 Trend

REPEAT EVERY QUARTER

Last check (date and total): _____

This check (total out of 60): _____

Next check: _____

"Which practice, if it improved, would make releasing least scary?"

"Where do our scores disagree most, and why?"

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